

43~45번

Matthew loved tennis. He had been practicing hard for weeks, preparing for the biggest match of the year. Today was the day. He wanted to win. He had trained so much. His best friend and training partner Larry was on the sidelines, cheering him on. The match started off great. He ran across the court, hitting each ball with speed and precision. But then, SNAP! His racket strings broke! Matthew froze and his heart pounded as he stared at the loose strings hanging from his racket. He had never had a string break during a match before, and now it had happened in his most important match. The referee called for a short break while Matthew figured out what to do. He was about to give up when he heard a voice. "Use my spare!" He turned to see Larry holding out his extra racket. Matthew hesitated. It wasn't his racket. It wouldn't feel the same. But then he remembered something his coach always said, "Champions never give up." Taking a deep breath, he grabbed Larry's racket and returned to the court. The new racket was heavier than his own, and the grip wasn't as comfortable. He missed an easy ball, and his opponent scored a point. But instead of getting upset, Matthew told himself, 'It's okay. I just need to adapt.' He focused on his footwork and adjusted his grip. Despite his best efforts, things didn't go as Matthew hoped. And by the end of the match, he had lost. He had wanted to win so badly. As Matthew walked miserably to the net, he looked at his opponent. The boy was smiling, holding out his hand. He didn't want to admit his defeat. But then, he remembered something Larry always said: "Winning isn't about the score. It's about how you play the game." Matthew realized he had done his best. Matthew smiled, shook the boy's hand and said, "Congratulations. You played a great game."